



Run the business,
not the busywork.

DOCUMENT

scs.ai brand book
Direction 3 — Approachable Operator

OWNER

scs.ai LLC (Wyoming)
Designer handoff package

VERSION

v0.2 · May 16 2026

CONTENTS

Logo · Color · Type · Voice
Applications · Pressure tests
Usage · Deliverables

The soul of the work.

scs.ai is the operator's AI shell. It runs the operational layer of an SMB owner's business so they can focus on the work that compounds.

Think Notion's friendliness, Things 3's clarity, Linear's craft — applied to small-business operators who don't think of themselves as "AI customers" yet.

A solo esthetician, an auto dealer, a fractional CMO, a multi-business operator — they finally have **a teammate**, not another tool to learn.

Warm

A capable older sister who's been through it.

Direct

We don't bury the answer. Lead with what matters.

Confident

We know what we're doing, but we don't brag.

Humane

Operating a business is hard. We don't pretend AI fixes everything.

Three wordmark approaches.

The dot before .ai renders in terracotta — it becomes the brand mark even when separated from the wordmark. Approach A is the recommended default; commission A plus one variant of B for comparison.

RECOMMENDED

scs.ai

APPROACH A

Lowercase, dot-accent

Geist Medium, generous tracking. The terracotta period is the consistent signature across every variant.

scs.ai

APPROACH B

Custom letterform

Bespoke s and a, slightly rounder than stock. Distinctive but commissioned — revisit after Series Seed.

SCS.ai

APPROACH C

Caps + minor TLD

More authoritative, less warm. Test in pitch-deck context only — not customer-facing.

Three glyph approaches.

A glyph reads as approachable at marketing scale, professional on a contract, neutral as an app icon. Glyph A is warmth without infantilizing — the recommended default for Direction 3.

RECOMMENDED



GLYPH A

Smiling shell

Soft semicircle shell opening, two terracotta dots as friendly punctuation. Works 16px → 200px+.



GLYPH B

Interlocked rounded squares

Three squares, 25% rounded, ~30% overlap. The multi-tenant + tier-profile metaphor, without literal storytelling.



GLYPH C

Concentric rounded rings

Nested chambers / nested architecture. Most abstract — best for the developer sub-brand if cross-pollinated.

The lockup matrix.

Seven variants cover every context. Designer ships SVG masters; PNG exports derive at standard sizes. Never combine variants on the same page — pick one per context.



HORIZONTAL PRIMARY

MARKETING • EMAIL



STACKED PRIMARY

SQUARE ASPECT



MONOGRAM

FAVICON • AVATAR



INLINE WORDMARK

BODY • LEGAL



APP ICON

22% PADDING



SOCIAL AVATAR

1:1 CIRCULAR



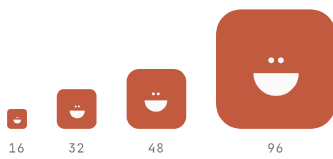
REVERSED HORIZONTAL

DARK MODE



REVERSED STACKED

DARK MODE



FAVICON SET

.ICO · 16 / 32 / 48 / 96

Colors that feel like a teammate.

Terracotta is the brand — one primary action per screen. Charcoal, never pure black. No gradients in branding contexts. Dark mode inverts background and foreground; terracotta accent stays.

PRIMARY PALETTE 80% USE

#FBFAF8

--warm-white

#FBFAF8

Primary background. Site, app body, dashboards.

#FFFFFF

--surface-white

#FFFFFF

Card and elevated surface on warm-white.

#1F1F1F

--charcoal

#1F1F1F

Primary text. Headlines, body, primary buttons.

#737373

--muted-text

#737373

Captions, labels, helper text, timestamps.

#C25A40

--terracotta

#C25A40

Primary brand accent. CTA, links, the brand dot.

SECONDARY PALETTE 20% ACCENT

#7C9A6D

--sage

#7C9A6D

Success, growth, positive indicators.

#E8E0D5

--beige

#E8E0D5

Section dividers, subtle backgrounds.

#9E4631

--terracotta-dark

#9E4631

Hover / active for terracotta.

#5F7B53

--sage-dark

#5F7B53

Hover / active for sage.

#7C9A6D

--success

#7C9A6D

Confirmation. Completion. Healthy state.

#E8A04E

--warning

#E8A04E

Caution. Soft warnings.

#C5544E

--danger

#C5544E

Error. Destructive action.

#5B7C99

--info

#5B7C99

Informational. Neutral notifications.

Usage rules

Read before applying color anywhere.

- Terracotta is the brand — one primary action per screen.
- Charcoal #1F1F1F, never pure black.
- No gradients in logo, button, or brand surfaces.
- Dark mode inverts background and foreground only.
- Charcoal on warm-white = 16.1:1 (AAA).
- Terracotta on warm-white = 3.8:1 — large / CTA only.

Two weights. Three families. Sentence case.

Ship Year 1 with Geist + Inter + JetBrains Mono — all free, all production-ready. Upgrade to Söhne after Series Seed if polish outweighs budget. Only 400 and 500 weights ever; no italics in marketing copy.

DISPLAY • HEADINGS • HERO

Aa

Geist • 400 / 500

fallback • Söhne

BODY • PARAGRAPHS • UI

Aa

Inter • 400 / 500

fallback • system-ui

MONO • CODE • TECHNICAL LABELS

Aa

JetBrains Mono • 400

fallback • SF Mono

DISPLAY XL

Run the business

56 / 40 px
weight 500
lh 1.05 • tr -1

H1

A teammate, not a tool

40 / 32 px
weight 500
lh 1.1 • tr -0.5

H2

Operating shell for SMBs

28 / 24 px
weight 500
lh 1.2 • tr -0.25

H3

Bookings, follow-ups, compliance

20 / 18 px
weight 500
lh 1.3 · tr 0

BODY L

It handles the social posts, the bookings, the follow-ups — so you can focus on the work only you can do.

18 / 16 px
weight 400
lh 1.6 · tr 0

BODY M

Set up in a weekend. We've got you.

16 / 15 px
weight 400
lh 1.6 · tr 0

BODY S

This week your DMs got 47 booking inquiries.

14 / 13 px
weight 400
lh 1.5 · tr 0.1

CAPTION

Last synced 4 minutes ago · 7 actions waiting

13 / 12 px
weight 400
lh 1.45 · tr 0.2

MONO INLINE

tenant.profile.tier = "storefront-multi"

14 / 13 px
weight 400
lh 1.5 · tr 0

Usage rules

Read before setting any text.

- Two weights only — 400 and 500.
- Sentence case everywhere; never Title Case.
- No mid-sentence bolding in body copy.
- Italics reserved for editorial pull-quotes.
- Mono never in marketing copy or headlines.
- No exclamation points anywhere. Zero.

Words that sound like a teammate.

The brand voice is the brand. Lead with what matters. Use real numbers, real outcomes. Acknowledge that operating a business is hard.

✓ Words we use

"You," "your business," "your clients"

"Run" — run the business, not the busywork

"Operator," "shell," "tier," "profile"

"We've got you," "I got you"

"In a weekend," "by next Tuesday"

"Stop juggling tools"

AFFILIATE & TRADELINE LANGUAGE

"Business credit reporting" — tradeline furnisher to D&B, Experian, SBFE

"Funding partners," "we'll connect you"

"We'll send a warm intro"

✗ Words we do not use

"Game-changing," "revolutionary," "disrupt"

"AI-powered," "AI-driven," "intelligent automation"

"Enterprise-grade," "mission-critical"

"Easy," "simple," "effortless"

"Empower," "unlock potential," "transform"

Exclamation points — zero in marketing

AFFILIATE & TRADELINE LANGUAGE

"We arrange financing"

"Loans," "lending," "underwriting"

"Credit repair," "credit-builder"

"Build your credit" — we report, not repair

✓ ON-VOICE

"This week your DMs got 47 booking inquiries. I drafted replies for the 31 that fit your hours."

× OFF-VOICE

"Our AI-powered intelligent automation system processed 47 high-intent inbound conversion opportunities."

The system, applied.

Five surfaces where Direction 3 lives: marketing site, tenant dashboard, pitch deck title slide, email signature, app icon. Each holds the same warmth at a different fidelity.

MARKETING SITE • HERO

scs.ai/ • light mode

scs.ai

ProductPricingStoriesLogin

Get started

Run the business, not the busywork.

scs.ai is an operating shell for small-business operators. It handles the social posts, the bookings, the follow-ups, the business credit reporting, the compliance reminders — so you can focus on the work only you can do.

Start your shellWatch a 90-second demo

TRUSTED BY

Royal FacesBloom & BrewColiseum Motor GroupAbundant Living[open slot]

TENANT DASHBOARD

app.scs.ai • Royal Faces

Royal Faces Bloom & Brew

BOOKINGS THIS WEEK

47

↑ 12 vs last week

DRAFTS TO REVIEW

31

fit your hours

COMPLIANCE

30d

CA license renewal

YOUR BUSINESS CREDIT

D&B PAYDEX • reported monthly



78

↑ 4 from last month

Action queue

7 waiting • 12 cleared today

Maya R. asked about a Thursday 4pm slot — your calendar shows it's open.

EditSend reply

Jordan K. rebooking from last month. Drafted a confirm + the pre-care note.

EditSend reply



MAY 2026
Multi-tenant AI operating system
for SMB operators

EMAIL SIGNATURE

Gmail / Outlook · light

Marcus Lloyd

Founder · scs.ai



marcus@scs.ai · scs.ai · phone tbd

APP ICON FAMILY

iOS · Android · macOS



Does it hold up in the wild?

Two adversarial checks before the brand ships. The glyph next to its real favicon neighbors. The app icon on a B2B operator's home screen. If either reads juvenile or out-of-category, we dial the warmth back 15–20% — flatten the smile arc, or shift one eye dot to charcoal so the face reads less prominently.

TEST 01 • FAVICON AT 16 / 32 PX

In a browser-tab lineup, does the smiling shell read as another social app, or as professional infrastructure? Compared at native pixel scale.

OURS



scs.ai

S

S

Stripe

qb

qb

QuickBooks

S

S

Shopify

HL

HL

GoHighLevel

N

N

Notion

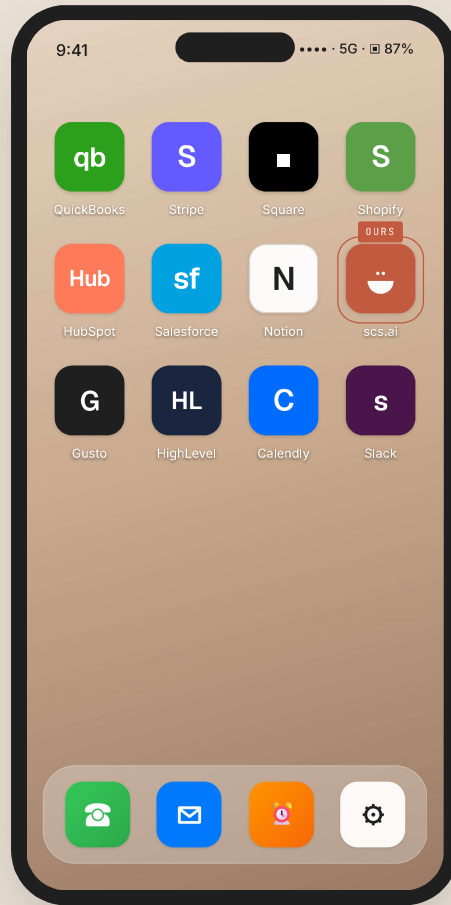
R

R

Reddit

FINDING

At 32px the smiling shell holds against the lineup — it reads as a category-of-its-own, neither finance-cold nor social-playful. At 16px the two eye-dots start to flatten into a single mark, which is the desired behavior; the silhouette stays distinct. Recommend ship as-is. Revisit only if six weeks of customer testing surfaces a "looks like a chat app" signal.



LINEUP COMPOSITION

QuickBooks, Stripe, Square, Shopify, HubSpot, Salesforce, Notion, Gusto, HighLevel, Calendly, Slack — the operator's working set. scs.ai sits in row 2 column 4, next to Notion (the warmth peer) and above HighLevel (the closest direct competitor).

FINDING

The terracotta-on-charcoal reading **holds against the financial blues and procedural greens**. The smiling shell does not register as a kids' or social app in this set — the proximity to Notion's monogrammed mark actually **reinforces the "craft software" lane**.

Watch-item: at 1× home-screen scale, the two eye-dots are within ~3px of merging. If iOS 19's icon scaling shifts, the dots may need to grow by 10% to preserve face-recognition. **No change to v0.2.**

Do, and do not.

Eight rules on each side. Read once, then follow forever. When in doubt, default to less — terracotta is a signal, not a fill color.

✓ Do

- Use Approach A wordmark + Glyph A as the default lockup.
- Maintain at least 0.5× glyph-height clear space around every lockup.
- Render logos at minimum 24px height (digital) or 12mm (print).
- Use the terracotta dot as a brand signature beyond the wordmark — list bullets, footer separators, sentence-ending accents in marketing copy.
- Apply Direction 3 voice consistently — email, marketing, in-product, social.
- Hold one primary terracotta action per screen.
- Default to sentence case. Always.
- Use real numbers, real names, real outcomes.

✗ Do not

- Recolor the wordmark. Charcoal + terracotta dot is the system.
- Apply gradients, shadows, glows, or strokes to the logo.
- Stretch, skew, rotate, or 3D-extrude the glyph.
- Place the logo on busy photographic backgrounds without a flat overlay.
- Combine multiple lockup variants on the same page — pick one per context.
- Use the wordmark below 14px height — use the monogram instead.
- Write in Title Case, ALL CAPS, or with exclamation points.
- Use "AI-powered," "revolutionary," "game-changing," or any other hype word.

The deliverables package.

Twelve files in the handoff envelope. Recommended for Year 1: Fiverr Pro designer at \$800–1,200 with this brand book as the brief. Iterate twice. Lock by week 3. File naming: scs-ai__[variant]__[mode]__[size].[ext]

01	Master SVG — horizontal primary lockup (glyph + wordmark)	.svg • light + dark
02	Master SVG — stacked primary lockup	.svg • light + dark
03	Master SVG — monogram (glyph only)	.svg • light + dark
04	Master SVG — inline wordmark (no glyph)	.svg • light + dark
05	PNG exports of all SVGs at 1× / 2× / 3×	.png • 24–512px
06	Favicon set	.ico • 16 / 32 / 48 / 96
07	App icon — terracotta rounded-square, glyph centered	.png • 1024×1024
08	Social avatars — Twitter, LinkedIn, Instagram	.png • 400×400
09	Color tokens — CSS variables + Tailwind + Figma styles JSON	.css • .js • .json
10	Type tokens — font stacks, scale, weight references	.css • .json
11	Brand guidelines PDF — do's / don'ts, clear space, minimum sizes	.pdf • 1–2 pages
12	IP transfer — work-for-hire assignment to scs.ai LLC (Wyoming)	.pdf • executed



We've got you.

DOCUMENT Direction 3 · Approachable Operator
STATUS Locked — ready for designer handoff
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